

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 777

By Atchley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Lieutenant Gordon Gwathney of Knoxville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the untimely passing of Lieutenant Gordon Gwathney of the Knoxville Police Department; and

WHEREAS, Lieutenant Gwathney was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in 1968 and raised in Sevier County, Gordon Gwathney learned the values of hard work, integrity, and selfless service that would define his life at an early age; and

WHEREAS, Lieutenant Gwathney proudly served his country as a member of the United States Army, a tenure that included a deployment to Korea, and later continued his honorable service in the Tennessee National Guard; and

WHEREAS, dedicated to serving and protecting his community, Gordon Gwathney joined the Knoxville Police Department in 1997 and rose through the ranks with distinction, being promoted to Sergeant in 2003 and to Lieutenant in 2010; and

WHEREAS, known affectionately throughout East Knoxville as "Officer G," Lieutenant Gwathney was beloved by the community he served; his friendly and compassionate nature, along with his unwavering commitment to community policing, earned him the respect and admiration of his colleagues and the citizens of Knoxville alike; and

WHEREAS, early in his career, he was assigned as the first-ever School Resource Officer at Austin-East High School, where he formed countless lasting relationships and served as a positive influence and mentor to many young people; and

WHEREAS, Lieutenant Gwathney's professional excellence was recognized by the Knoxville Police Department, which named him Officer of the Year in 2013 and again nominated him for the honor in 2019; and

WHEREAS, Lieutenant Gordon Gwathney leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Lieutenant Gordon Gwathney, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Lieutenant Gwathney.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.